

If you already haven't installed MySQL, you can do so by running and following the online instructions:

```
$yum install mysql
```

Connect to MySQL and create the database 'phplist' as follows:

```
$mysql -u[your username] -p[your password]
```

Then, at the MySQL prompt, type:

```
mysql> create database phplist;
Query OK, 1 row affected (0.00 sec)
```

Configure PHPList to connect to MySQL

Let's configure PHPList to connect to the database that we just created. Open the `config` file available in the `lists/config/` directory using Nano, and replace the values for the database user and password.

```
nano phplist-3.0.6/public_html/lists/config/config.php
```

```
# what is your Mysql database server hostname
$database_host = "localhost";

# what is the name of the database we are using
$database_name = "phplist";

# what user has access to this database
$database_user = "your username";

# and what is the password to login to control the database
$database_password = 'your password';

# if test is true (not 0) it will not actually send ANY
# messages, but display what it would have sent
# this is here, to make sure you edited the config file and
# mails are not sent "accidentally"
# on unmanaged systems
define ("TEST",0);
```

DNS entries

Now, set up a domain (www.yourdomain.in) and point the A record to your IP address. Set up your Apache or NGINX server virtual host document root to point to the directory `phplist-3.0.6/public_html/` and restart your server. (The Apache configuration files are available in `/etc/httpd/conf.d` and those of Nginx are available under `/etc/nginx/conf.d`)

PHPList configuration

Fire up your browser and visit <http://www.yourdomain.in/admin>. You should see the PHPList dashboard (Figure 1).

Click the initial database link and follow the instructions.

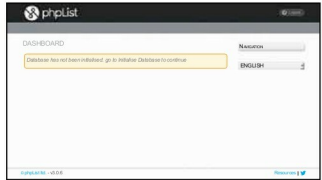


Figure 1: PHPList dashboard



Figure 2: Installing the database

PHPList will be installed within a few seconds (Figure 2). Do the developers a favour and tell them that you have installed PHPList by clicking the 'Tell us about it' button. Then click 'phPList Setup' to continue with the installation.

Click on *Verify settings*. Use `admin` for the login name and the password you provided during the installation in order to log in. Let's not change any other settings, for now.

Click the *Configure* attributes. PHPList has a set of default lists that can be used while creating newsletters. We'll load the following by clicking the *Predefined Defaults* and then clicking *Countries in the world* and *States in India*. Then click on the *Add button*.

Having done this, let's create a *Subscribe* page. Click on *Create subscribe page* and create a page to subscribe to your newsletter (Figure 3).

Let's now add some subscribers to our list. Just copy and paste a few emails in the box, click the *Import* button and you are done (Figure 4).

Before we send out campaign mails, we should set a few domain entries. This is to ensure that our bulk mails are not flagged as spam at the receiving end. For this, we have to follow some of the best practices as espoused by large webmail providers like Gmail.

Finalise an IP address

The first step is to finalise the IP address for your PHPList. If